

# Standard International System of Units (SI) Prefixes

| Prefix | Symbol | Factor ( $10^n$ ) | Decimal           | English Equivalent |
|--------|--------|-------------------|-------------------|--------------------|
| tera   | T      | $10^{12}$         | 1000000000000     | trillion           |
| giga   | G      | $10^9$            | 1000000000        | billion            |
| mega   | M      | $10^6$            | 1000000           | million            |
| kilo   | k      | $10^3$            | 1000              | thousand           |
| deci   | d      | $10^{-1}$         | 0.1               | tenth              |
| centi  | c      | $10^{-2}$         | 0.01              | hundredth          |
| milli  | m      | $10^{-3}$         | 0.001             | thousandth         |
| micro  | $\mu$  | $10^{-6}$         | 0.000001          | millionth          |
| nano   | n      | $10^{-9}$         | 0.000000001       | billionth          |
| pico   | p      | $10^{-12}$        | 0.000000000001    | trillionth         |
| femto  | f      | $10^{-15}$        | 0.000000000000001 | quadrillionth      |

## A few examples:

$$1 \text{ km} = 10^3 \text{ m}$$

$$5 \text{ mg} = 5 \times 10^{-3} \text{ g}$$

$$7 \text{ cs} = 7 \times 10^{-2} \text{ s}$$